

Bristol / Open to relocation (UK)

[Portfolio]: lukeacooper.github.io/gamedev-portfolio/

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LUKE COOPER

SUMMARY

TIGA Award-nominated Technical Artist/Designer and Games Technology graduate, specialising in Technical Level Design, and more generalised game development roles. Proven experience co-founding a student cooperative to commercially ship a title on Steam. Highly proficient in Unreal Engine 5, Maya and Blender, with proven experience in leading data-driven player testing and executing professional workflows within multidisciplinary agile teams.

Seeking roles within game development which align with my skillset.

GAME DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE

Horseplay Interactive (University Cooperative) | Game Developer / Generalist

Project: *Pantomime Horse Obstacle Course (PHOC)* (Steam Release)

- Co-founded a 10-person multidisciplinary studio to concept, develop and commercially publish a title on Steam, exceeding academic requirements to deliver a market-ready product.
- Nominated as a Finalist for 'Best Student Game' at the TIGA UK Games Education Awards 2026 (Winner announcement pending).
- Headed data-driven player research, collating and analysing qualitative feedback from Alpha/Beta questionnaires to identify player trends and directly inform design iterations.
- Designed and modeled 3D player character meshes, collaborating within the team to iterate, optimise and integrate them into Unreal Engine 5.
- Authored modular Niagara VFX systems, including a complex victory fireworks display, using custom mesh shapes to sequence text elements, and a layered wind particle effect attached to a fan obstacle.
- Championed Agile methodologies, actively driving weekly Scrum meetings, continuous idea generation, and cross-functional collaboration.
- Co-managed marketing and live events, including designing marketing material, and Steam capsule content, an interactive, convention-style exhibition booth featuring custom branding, player competitions, and community engagement rewards.
- Enforced production workflows using Jira and Git, establishing strict peer-review code protocols to safeguard main branch stability.

GAME JAM CONTRIBUTIONS | Playable via [Itch.io](https://itch.io)

Global Game Jam 2026 – *Developer*

- Collaborated within a small team to build ‘Paint The Town Neon’; a 2D cyber-punk pixel platformer.
- Handled asset creation / integration and level design.
- Worked closely alongside peers to create ideas and develop a game over the duration of the Global Game Jam.

UWE Starting Block Game Jam 2026 – *Mentor & Developer*

- Invited by university faculty to mentor current students on project troubleshooting and game design.
- Co-developed ‘Smash That Sacrifice Button’, designing upgrade icons for UI.
- Rendered low-poly 3D meshes downscaled into 2D sprites and constructed the primary environment scene.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Games Technology (Upper Second Class) – UWE Bristol

2022 – 2026

- Languages & Engines: C++, C, Python, Unreal Engine 5, Unity.
- Tools & Workflows: Autodesk Maya, Blender, Substance Painter, Git, Jira, Agile development.

Computing and IT Practice (Foundation Degree) | The Open University

2020 – 2022